

# Wednesday, 23 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

## Tomorrow's forecast

|                               |                               |                               |                            |
|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|----------------------------|
| LONDON<br>Overcast<br>22° 16° | BIRMINGHAM<br>Rain<br>20° 13° | MANCHESTER<br>Rain<br>19° 12° | GLASGOW<br>Rain<br>17° 11° |
|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|----------------------------|

01 — NEWS

## Today's top stories

- 1

**The Chancellor is facing increased pressure ahead of the Budget after an unexpected surge in UK borrowing last month.**

Borrowing was much higher than anticipated in August, as inflation continues to put a squeeze on the government's finances. This news comes just weeks before the crucial Budget announcement.

ECONOMY · UK
- 2

**New EU industry rules could cause significant damage to the UK, according to a stark warning from Prime Minister Rishi Sunak.**

Mr. Sunak is expected to raise his concerns directly with the European Commission President when they meet later today. The proposed regulations have sparked worry about their potential impact on British businesses.

POLITICS · UK
- 3

**The family of a British couple being held in Iran say they have no regular contact with them, despite earlier promises.**

Craig and Lindsay Foreman's relatives were told they would have contact after the couple ended their hunger strikes. Their situation remains a source of deep concern.

INTERNATIONAL · UK
- 4

**New rules mean vet prescription fees will now be capped, offering potential relief for pet owners across the country.**

Vets will also be required to inform clients if cheaper medication is available to buy online. Surgeries have several months to implement these important changes.

CONSUMER · UK
- 5

**A British man is missing after reportedly diving into Italy's Lake Como to rescue a struggling teenager.**

Local officials say the man jumped into the water to help a father and son who were in difficulty. Search efforts are currently underway.

HUMAN INTEREST · UK

## What's coming up

### 1 **Burberry brought London Fashion Week 2026 to a spectacular close, showcasing its signature check print to a star-studded front row.**

The iconic British brand wrapped up the fashion extravaganza with a collection that highlighted its heritage. Celebrities flocked to see the latest designs, setting trends for the season ahead.

**ON AIR** – What's your favourite fashion trend that's come out of London Fashion Week this year?

FASHION · THIS WEEK

### 2 **Actress Daisy Edgar-Jones has revealed how her childhood summers in the fields of Fermanagh helped her prepare for her latest film role.**

Daisy, whose mother hails from County Down, spent many long holidays in Northern Ireland. She drew on these experiences to bring authenticity to her new character.

**ON AIR** – Have you ever found inspiration for something unexpected from your own childhood memories?

FILM · COMING UP

### 3 **Sir Sean Connery's family are planning to open a new filmmaking centre in Edinburgh, honouring the legendary James Bond actor.**

The centre will be named after Connery, who famously worked as a milkman in the Scottish capital before achieving Hollywood stardom. It aims to inspire the next generation of filmmakers.

**ON AIR** – What's your favourite Sean Connery film, and why?

FILM · FUTURE

### 4 **Apple Music is set to open its very own concert venue right here in London, located at the iconic Battersea Power Station.**

The tech giant has built a dedicated concert hall, promising a new space for live music in the capital. They insist they're not looking to compete with smaller, independent venues.

**ON AIR** – Would you be excited to see a gig at a venue opened by Apple Music?

MUSIC · FUTURE

### 5 **Fans are getting their first glimpse of the highly anticipated Christmas special for the popular show, 'The Other Bennet Sister'.**

Filming for the festive episode wrapped up back in October, building excitement for its return to screens. Viewers are eagerly awaiting to see what's in store for the Bennet family.

**ON AIR** – Which TV Christmas special are you most looking forward to this year?

TV · CHRISTMAS

## On the schedule

### 1 **Kylian Mbappe has revealed he was 'close' to joining Liverpool back in 2016, with his mum being a big fan of Jurgen Klopp.**

The French superstar admitted his mother was keen for him to move to Merseyside during Klopp's tenure. It's a fascinating 'what if' for Reds supporters.

**ON AIR** – How differently do you think Liverpool's history might have played out if Mbappe had joined them?

FOOTBALL · UK

### 2 **Britain's Jack Catterall is one step closer to a second world title shot after being ordered to fight Teofimo Lopez for his world title.**

Catterall narrowly missed out on the world title in 2022, but now has another chance to claim the coveted belt. It sets up a huge fight for British boxing fans.

**ON AIR** – Do you think Jack Catterall can go all the way and become world champion this time?

BOXING · UK

### 3 **Great Britain has fallen 1-0 behind the Czech Republic in the Billie Jean King Cup after Sonay Kartal was narrowly beaten.**

Marie Bouzkova secured the first singles rubber for the Czechs, putting pressure on the British team. There's still plenty to play for in the tie.

**ON AIR** – Do you think Great Britain can turn this around and win the Billie Jean King Cup tie?

TENNIS · UK

### 4 **Red Bull driver Isack Hadjar is set to make his return at this week's Azerbaijan Grand Prix after recovering from a wrist injury.**

Hadjar has missed the last three races, so his return will be a boost for the team. All eyes will be on him to see how he performs back on the track.

**ON AIR** – Are you excited to see Isack Hadjar back in action at the Azerbaijan Grand Prix this weekend?

F1 · THIS WEEK

### 5 **Wales captains Dewi Lake and Jac Morgan are preparing to make their Premiership debuts for Gloucester this weekend.**

The duo have moved from Ospreys and will be looking to make an immediate impact for their new club. It's an exciting time for Welsh rugby fans to see them in a new league.

**ON AIR** – How do you think Lake and Morgan will fare in the English Premiership with Gloucester?

RUGBY · UK

## Quick hits

- 1 Britain's appetite for 'cosy' nights in is reshaping Friday nights.**  
Takeaway and streaming bookings now peak earlier in the evening, as more of us swap the big night out for a big night in.
- 2 The 'silver gamer' is the fastest-growing demographic in UK gaming — over-65s spent £180 million on games last year.**  
Cosy life-sim titles like Stardew Valley and Animal Crossing dominate. Console makers are reportedly designing larger UI for the market.
- 3 More of us are taking up 'fake commutes' — a short walk before and after working from home.**  
Psychologists say the made-up journey helps separate work from home life. Some people even pop to a shop and back to 'arrive'.
- 4 The most-Googleed DIY question in Britain this year: 'how to remove silicone'.**  
Tradespeople say it's the rise of botched bathroom resealing jobs during lockdown that's still haunting people. YouTube tutorials on the topic have racked up 60 million views.
- 5 'Quiet' holidays are the new luxury, with travellers seeking places with nothing much to do.**  
Tour operators report rising demand for remote cottages and slow trains. The number one requested feature: a reliable kettle and a view.
- 6 Charity shops are reporting a surge in both donations and shoppers as 'pre-loved' goes mainstream.**  
Younger shoppers in particular are hunting for one-off finds. Volunteers say the most donated item by a mile is the unworn 'someday' outfit.
- 7 Swimming in the sea and lakes — 'wild swimming' — keeps growing in popularity year-round.**  
Enthusiasts swear by the cold-water buzz. Newcomers are advised to start gently, and that the gasp on entry is completely normal.

05 – TALKBACK

## For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

**Q** 58% of us admit we judge a person instantly based on THIS.

**ANSWER:** HOW THEY TREAT WAITING STAFF.

**Q** Asked the most satisfying household sound, the winner was THIS.

**ANSWER:** THE CLICK OF THE KETTLE AS IT FINISHES BOILING.

TALK TOPIC

- **A new study says we form a strong opinion of someone within 7 seconds of meeting them.**  
Talk-back: what's the quickest you've ever decided you didn't like someone — and were you right? Or the quickest you DID like someone?

- **Matching pet-and-owner outfits are apparently making a comeback this summer.**  
Would you actually do it? And if so — does the dog get a vote in the wardrobe?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

**FACT** **Sport.** A grassroots football club in the Lake District plays its home games on a pitch with a 1-in-12 slope at one end — the steepest legal gradient for organised football.

**FICTION** **Made up, but believable.** A 5-a-side league in Slough has banned all 'celebration sliding' after three players in one season tore their shorts and demanded refunds.

06 – LOTTERY

## Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

**£25 million**

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

**£3.8 million**

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

## Did you know?

- A cloud can weigh more than a million pounds — about the same as 100 elephants. They float because they're spread across miles of sky.
- Honey never spoils. Edible honey has been found in 3,000-year-old Egyptian tombs.
- Octopuses have three hearts and blue blood. Two pump blood through the gills, the third pumps it round the body.
- The Eiffel Tower can grow up to 15cm taller in summer because the iron expands in the heat.
- The dot above a lowercase 'i' or 'j' has a name — it's called a tittle.
- Bananas are technically berries. Strawberries, somehow, are not.
- Wombats produce cube-shaped poo. Scientists worked out it's the elasticity of their intestines.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time — 1/100th of a second. So 'back in a jiffy' is the fastest promise you can make.

## On this day

Day 266 of the year, 99 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Adomnán; Christian feast day: Blessed Bernardyna Maria Jabłońska; Christian feast day: Cissa of Crowland (or of Northumbria); Christian feast day: Blessed Elena Duglioli. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

### TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1959 — Jason Alexander, American actor, singer, and voice artist
- 1977 — Rachael Yamagata, American singer-songwriter and pianist
- 1945 — Paul Petersen, American actor, singer, author, and activist
- 1944 — Eric Bogle, Scottish-Australian singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1972 — Karl Pilkington, English actor and producer
- 1976 — Robert James-Collier, English actor
- 1958 — Danielle Dax, English singer-songwriter and producer
- 1978 — Anthony Mackie, American actor

### THE DAY TODAY

- 2010 — Teresa Lewis becomes the first woman to be executed by the U.S. state of Virginia since 1912, and the first woman in the state to be executed by lethal injection.
- 1950 — Korean War: The Battle of Hill 282 is the first US friendly-fire incident on British military personnel since World War II.
- 1957 — Little Rock schools integration crisis: President Dwight D. Eisenhower sends the 101st Airborne Division to Little Rock, Arkansas, and federalizes the Arkansas National Guard, ordering both to support the integration of Little Rock Central High School.

### TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1967 — Seven people die, 46 people are injured, and more than 150 boats capsize when a squall hits Lake Michigan during Michigan's first coho salmon sport fishing season.
- 1957 — Little Rock schools integration crisis: President Dwight D. Eisenhower sends the 101st Airborne Division to Little Rock, Arkansas, and federalizes the Arkansas National Guard, ordering both to support the integration of Little Rock Central High School.

### TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1955 — An all-white jury in Mississippi finds Roy Bryant and J. W. Milam not guilty in the torture-murder of 14-year-old African American boy Emmett Till.

- 1973 — Argentine general election: Juan Perón returns to power in Argentina.
- 2024 — Israel launches airstrikes against Hezbollah targets in Lebanon, killing more than 490 people.

## A peek at tomorrow

Day 267 of the year, 98 days left in 2026. Today Armed Forces Day (Peru); Christian feast day: Anathalon (in Brescia); Christian feast day: Antonio Gonzalez; Christian feast day: Blessed Anton Martin Slomšek. Star sign Libra, birthstone Sapphire.

### TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1946 — Pat Pocock, Welsh-English cricketer
- 1969 — Shamim Sarif, English author, director, and screenwriter
- 1962 — Ally McCoist, Scottish footballer and manager
- 1941 — Linda McCartney, American singer, photographer, and activist (died 1998)
- 1944 — Victoria Vetri, Playboy's 1967 Miss September and 1968 Playmate of the Year.
- 1942 — Gerry Marsden, English singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2021)
- 1993 — Ben Platt, American actor, singer, and songwriter
- 1973 — Eddie George, American football player and sportscaster

### THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1950 — The eastern United States is covered by a thick haze from the Chinchaga fire in western Canada.
- 2023 — NASA's OSIRIS-REx capsule containing samples from the asteroid 101955 Bennu successfully lands back on Earth.
- 1954 — The Cochabamba–Santa Cruz highway connecting western and eastern Bolivia is inaugurated.

### TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2014 — The Mars Orbiter Mission makes India the first Asian nation to reach Mars orbit, and the first nation in the world to do so in its first attempt.
- 2009 — South African Airlink Flight 8911 crashes near Durban International Airport in Durban, South Africa, killing the captain and injuring the rest of the crew.

# Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 25                      Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16                      Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23                      Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

## On the sporting calendar